NEPQ Phase 4 — Solution Awareness

Cheat sheet · 5 Nov 2026

Purpose

Move the prospect from **"I have a problem"** to **"I can see life with it solved, and I want it."** Knowing about a problem rarely makes people act; most wait until it becomes a crisis. Picturing the result is what creates urgency.

Do / Don't

Do	Don't
Let them describe their ideal outcome	Describe your product's features
Get both tangible and emotional benefits	Stop at logic ("more money")
Ask "what *does* it feel like" (present tense)	Ask "what *would* it feel like" (keeps it distant)
Let them measure the gap themselves	Tell them how far behind they are

The question flow

Step	Example question
1. Ideal criteria	"If you found the perfect solution, what would it need to have?"
2. Tangible result	"If that problem was solved, what would change for you?"
3. Emotional result	"And how does that feel, being there?"
4. Visualise	"Picture it's 6 months from now and it's sorted. What does your day look like?"
5. The gap	"How close are you to that right now?"

Future pacing: paint two futures, one where it's solved and one where nothing changes. The tension between them is what drives action. Phase 5 (Consequences) works the second future.

Applied to TRB: gym owners, after pain discovery

Use **their** pain from Phase 3, in their words. Still no product. You are building the picture they will want to buy into later.

Step	Gym owner version
Ideal criteria	"If you could fix [their pain], what would the ideal fix look like for you? What would it need to do?"
Tangible	"If [their pain] was sorted, what changes? Members, revenue, hours you work?"
Emotional	"And how does that feel, not having to worry about it?"
Visualise	"Imagine it's summer and the gym is exactly where you want it. What does a normal week look like?"
The gap	"Honestly, how far are you from that right now?"

Why the ideal criteria step matters for you: their answers are your product spec. "I don't want another app to manage" or "it has to run itself" tells you what to build and how to pitch it.

Log it: next to each pain in your CRM Pains tab, add their ideal outcome and the emotion behind it. Those exact phrases make your best headlines.

Self-check after each call

☐ Did they describe the ideal fix in their own words?

☐ Do I know the tangible result AND how it feels?

☐ Did they picture it in the present tense?

☐ Did they admit the gap between now and there?

☐ Did I still keep my product out of it?

Next phase: Consequences, meaning what happens if nothing changes, and what they never get to have.